

other. Milton's Paradise of Fools, located on the outermost "sphere" of the Ptolemaic "world," is another interesting literary parallel.

Some other details in Zarathushtra's eschatology will emerge from the reading of the Gathas as given below. What has been said will suffice for a general picture of his system. Later accretions, consistent or incongruous, may be examined in Söderblom's great monograph, in Casartelli's authoritative account of Sassanian Parsism, and in Böklen's suggestive but too ingenious exposition of parallels between Parsi and Jewish eschatology. A few general observations must suffice here.

Specifically Magian eschatology was probably limited to speculations as to a new heaven and a new earth. We have the authority of Theopompus for their belief in immortality, but even Theopompus is not nearly ancient enough to guarantee his evidence as applying to Magianism apart from the Iranian and the strictly Zarathushtrian elements which they assimilated. Of course, I must admit in my turn that to *prove* the absence of an individual eschatology in original Magianism lies outside the evidence. There is one obvious point of view from which Magianism would naturally come to a belief in immortality. Death is conspicuously the creation of Ahriman, one of whose standing epithets is *pouru-mahrka*, "many-slaying." Even, then, if immortality formed no part of the original doctrine of the Magi—and it seems to me improbable that it did belong to their system before they took up Zoroastrianism—it would be commended to them by their tendency to make the world evenly divided between